

Chapter 132-1

Zhao Xuning had just finished assisting with a surgery and came out of the operating room to take off her sterile gown.

Before she even had time to wash her hands, she overheard people chatting nearby.

"Those two downstairs are so beautiful."

"Watching them makes me want to fall in love too... What kind of idol drama come to life is this?"

"What are you all talking about?" someone asked, confused.

"The patient from the seventeenth floor. She ran out as soon as she woke up and happened to run into her wife downstairs."

"Today happens to be the first snow too! Kissing in the snow—it's so romantic I could die from shipping them."¹

"If I remember correctly, the patient on the seventeenth floor seems to be Dr. Zhao's friend."

"....."

A nurse poked the person who was talking beside her. Zhao Xuning happened to be passing by.

The topic came to an abrupt halt, and there was even some awkwardness in the air.

The nurses exchanged glances with each other.

Zhao Xuning adjusted her glasses, maintaining her cool and aloof demeanor. "The patient on seventeen woke up?"

Someone answered nervously: "Just woke up. She's downstairs now."

Zhao Xuning: "Oh."

Her tone was always detached. When she first arrived at the hospital, she had rejected quite a few doctors and nurses who tried to chat her up.

She claimed she didn't do office romances.

People from other departments also tried to approach her, but she said the medical field was too busy, and she didn't really like dating colleagues.

She basically rejected everyone without offending them.

She had always been a loner at the hospital, without any close friends.

Mainly because Zhao Xuning was young, yet her position was not low.

In all the hospitals in Haizhou City, she was the only one who had reached such a position at her age.

Most medical students were already nearly thirty by the time they finished their studies. Even with an eight-year combined bachelor's-master's-doctoral program, they still had to slowly work their way up at the hospital after graduating.

Yet Zhao Xuning was exceptionally good at creating miracles.

This was also why no one dared to treat her like a newly arrived doctor—jokes and teasing were rare.

Geniuses always had a sense of distance from ordinary people.

On top of that, all of Zhao Xuning's casual clothes were designer brands—definitely not something a newly graduated medical student could afford. The car she drove to work cost over a million yuan. One look and you could tell her family background was extraordinary.

Over time, people started saying Zhao Xuning was their hospital's "flower on a high peak"²—only to be admired from afar, not to be touched.

At this moment, facing Zhao Xuning, everyone felt a bit uneasy.

Zhao Xuning was tactful enough. She only paused briefly before asking: "Who is she with?"

A young nurse said: "Just look out the window and you'll know... That scene is quite beautiful."

Zhao Xuning paused for a moment, pressed her lips together, and said coldly: "Thank you."

After saying this, she didn't look out the window as the young nurse had suggested.

She went all the way back to her office. Only after washing her hands did she stand by the window and casually opened it.

Snowflakes carrying a chill hit her face.

This heavy snow in Haizhou City had been building up with cold air for a long time. When it finally fell, it came down as fluttering, swirling heavy snow.

The ground and rooftops were quickly covered with a thick layer, dyeing the entire world white.

From Zhao Xuning's vantage point, she could see two people walking hand in hand in the heavy snow.

While everyone else was hiding from the snow, their heads, shoulders, and clothes were all covered with white snowflakes.

Zhao Xuning suddenly thought of a phrase: "Frost and snow blown upon our heads—that too counts as reaching white-haired old age together."³

Who had said this to her again?

—It was Shen Hui.

Footnotes:

¹ **"I could die from shipping them" (嗑生嗑死):** Internet slang where "嗑" (kē) means to "ship" a couple (support a romantic pairing). The phrase expresses extreme enthusiasm for a couple, literally meaning "shipping them to life and death"—being so invested in their romance that it consumes you.

² **"Flower on a high peak" (高嶺之花):** A Chinese expression describing someone who is beautiful and admirable but unapproachable, like a flower growing on a high mountain peak that can only be looked at from afar.

³ **"Frost and snow blown upon our heads—that too counts as reaching white-haired old age together" (霜雪吹滿頭，也算到白首):** A poetic phrase playing on the traditional Chinese romantic wish of "growing old together until our hair turns white" (白首). Here, having snow (white) blown onto their heads is likened to achieving that wish of being together until old age, even if temporarily through snowflakes rather than actual aging.